

Participating women means being safe

The **level** of women's participation **is** a good **barometer** to determine a country's place on the development **spectrum**. The **spotlight** on 'women-led development' this Women's Day **was in keeping with** India's efforts to become 'developed' by 2047. But the **rape** of two women near Hampi in Karnataka **made** the news. Women can **hardly** essay India's development if they are unable to safely participate in such efforts.

Women's participation is about enabling conditions, safety being a core **enabler**. Laws and punishments for crimes against women matter. Implementation of the law creates **deterrence** through **exemplary** punishment. But perfect implementation doesn't happen, **thereby** the aim should be to minimise **instances** of **violation**. Deterrence is only part of the story. Increasing women's participation means removing barriers to their participation. Preventive and **proactive measures** to improve women's safety on roads, in their workplaces, in public and not-so-public spaces **will** remove a major obstacle. An average of 86 rapes are reported every day in India. This does not include sexual harassment, **intimidation** and other forms of violence **directed** at women.



Improving women's **safety** via **pragmatic means** like better street lighting **will** have a positive outcome on **well-being** and ease of living. It requires creating **incentives** of drawing people back into public space through **mechanisms** like accessible, **reliable** and **affordable** public transport systems that will bring more people out, providing safety in numbers. It will change the design of commercial activities, in turn, changing town planning. Increasing **pedestrian** traffic will mean better lighting, etc. If India is serious about development, it must first become safer for women to come out and participate.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

[\[Practice Exercise\]](#)

Vocabulary

1. **Barometer** (noun) – Indicator, Measure, Gauge, Standard, Benchmark मापदंड
2. **Spectrum** (noun) – Range, Scope, Scale, Gamut, Span विस्तार
3. **Spotlight** (noun) – Attention, Focus, Limelight, Highlight, Publicity ध्यान
4. **In keeping with** (phrase) – Consistent with, In line with, According to, Compatible with, Conforming to के अनुरूप
5. **Hardly** (adverb) – Barely, Scarcely, Rarely, Almost not, Only just मुश्किल से
6. **Enabler** (noun) – Facilitator, Supporter, Promoter, Catalyst, Helper सक्षम करने वाला
7. **Deterrence** (noun) – Prevention, Discouragement, Hindrance, Obstacle, Restraint निवारण
8. **Exemplary** (adjective) – Ideal, Model, Perfect, Admirable, Outstanding उदाहरणात्मक
9. **Thereby** (adverb) – Consequently, Thus, Therefore, Hence, Accordingly जिससे
10. **Instance** (noun) – Example, Case, Occurrence, Situation, Event उदाहरण
11. **Violation** (noun) – Breach, Infringement, Offense, Transgression, Abuse उल्लंघन
12. **Proactive** (adjective) – Active, Initiative, Forward-looking, Preventive, Anticipatory सक्रिय
13. **Intimidation** (noun) – Threat, Bullying, Harassment, Coercion, Fear धमकी
14. **Direct** (verb) – Aim, Point, Guide, Channel, Focus निर्देशित करना
15. **Via** (preposition) – Through, By means of, Using, By way of, With the help of के माध्यम से
16. **Pragmatic** (adjective) – Practical, Realistic, Sensible, Logical, Down-to-earth व्यावहारिक
17. **Means** (noun) – Method, Way, Approach, Mode, Technique साधन
18. **Well-being** (noun) – Welfare, Health, Happiness, Comfort, Prosperity कल्याण
19. **Incentive** (noun) – Motivation, Encouragement, Stimulus, Inducement, Spur प्रोत्साहन
20. **Mechanism** (noun) – System, Process, Procedure, Method, Structure तंत्र
21. **Reliable** (adjective) – Dependable, Trustworthy, Consistent, Steady, Faithful विश्वसनीय

22. **Affordable** (adjective) – Inexpensive, Reasonable, Economical, Low-cost, Budget-friendly सस्ता

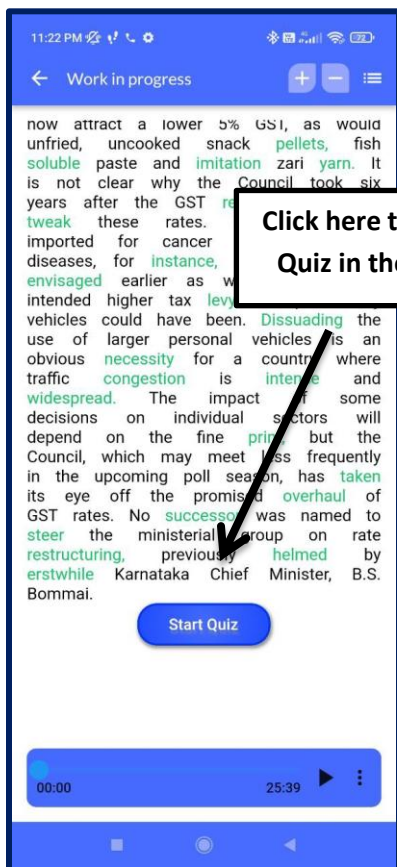
23. **Pedestrian** (adjective) – Ordinary, Common, Mundane, Uninspired, Dull साधारण

@mocks_wallah

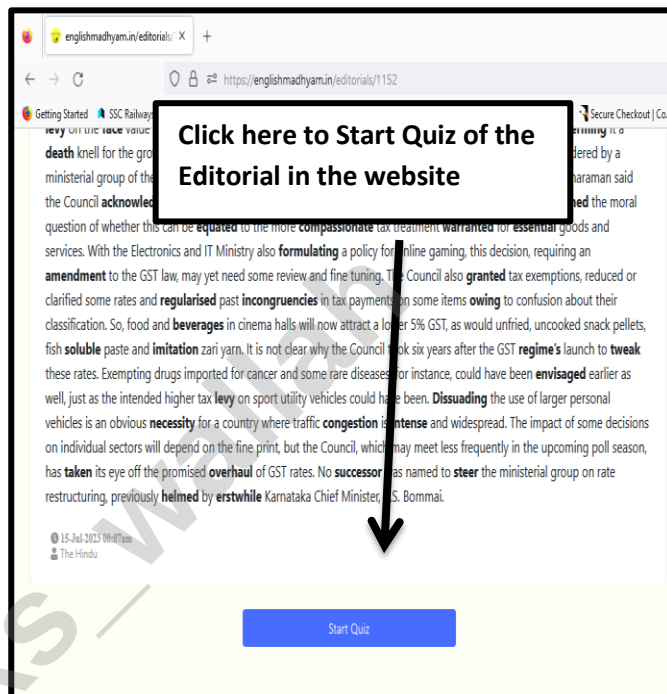
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Indicator of Development:** Women's participation levels are a key measure of a country's development progress.
2. **Women-Led Development:** India's focus on 'women-led development' aligns with its goal to become a developed nation by 2047.
3. **Safety as a Core Enabler:** Women's participation hinges on enabling conditions, with safety being a fundamental requirement.
4. **Recent Incident:** The rape of two women near Hampi, Karnataka, highlights the ongoing challenges to women's safety and participation.
5. **Legal Deterrence:** Effective implementation of laws and exemplary punishments for crimes against women are crucial for creating deterrence.
6. **Imperfect Implementation:** While perfect enforcement is challenging, the focus should be on minimizing violations.
7. **Beyond Deterrence:** Increasing women's participation requires removing barriers, not just punitive measures.
8. **Proactive Measures:** Preventive steps, such as improving safety in public spaces, workplaces, and transportation, are essential.
9. **Alarming Statistics:** An average of 86 rapes are reported daily in India, excluding other forms of violence and harassment against women.
10. **Pragmatic Solutions:** Better street lighting and safer public spaces can significantly improve women's safety and well-being.
11. **Public Transport:** Accessible, reliable, and affordable public transport systems can encourage more people, including women, to use public spaces.
12. **Safety in Numbers:** Increased pedestrian traffic can enhance safety and lead to better urban planning and infrastructure.
13. **Economic Impact:** Safer public spaces can transform commercial activities and town planning, fostering economic growth.
14. **Development Priority:** For India to achieve development, ensuring women's safety and participation must be a top priority.
15. **Holistic Approach:** A combination of legal, preventive, and infrastructural measures is needed to create an environment where women can safely contribute to development.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



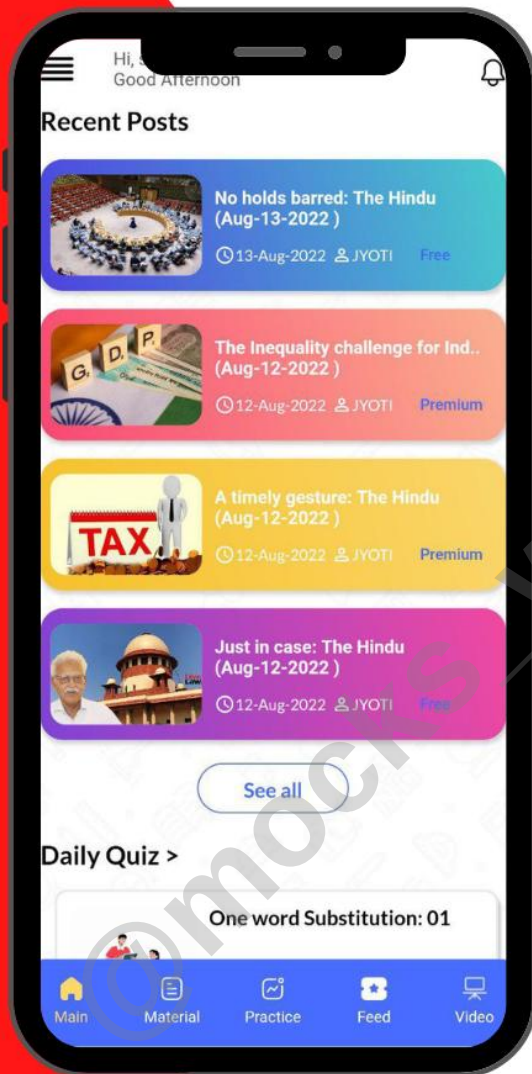
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